

104. Chapter 8 Verses 23-28

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 8.23

यत्र काले त्वनावृत्तिमावृत्तिं चैव योगिनः ।
प्रयाता यान्ति तं कालं वक्ष्यामि भरतर्षभ ॥ 23 ॥

yatra kāle tvanāvṛittim āvṛittim chaiva yoginaḥ
prayātā yānti taṁ kālaṁ vakṣhyāmi bharatarṣhabha

yatra—where; **kāle**—time; **tu**—certainly; **anāvṛittim**—no return; **āvṛittim**—return; **cha**—and; **eva**—certainly; **yoginaḥ**—a yogi; **prayātāḥ**—having departed; **yānti**—attain; **taṁ**—that; **kālam**—time; **vakṣhyāmi**—I shall describe; **bharatarṣhabha**—Arjun, the best of the Bharatas;

Now I will tell you, O greatest of the Bhāratas, the time in which the yogis depart never to return, and also the time in which they depart to return.

VERSE 8.24

अग्निज्योतिरहः शुक्लः षण्मासा उत्तरायणम् ।
तत्र प्रयाता गच्छन्ति ब्रह्म ब्रह्मविदो जनाः ॥ 24 ॥

agnir jyotir ahaḥ śhuklaḥ ṣhaṇ-māsā uttarāyaṇam
tatra prayātā gachchhanti brahma brahma-vido janāḥ

agniḥ—fire; **jyotiḥ**—light; **ahaḥ**—day; **śhuklaḥ**—the bright fortnight of the moon; **ṣhaṇ-māsāḥ**—six months; **uttara-ayanam**—the sun’s northern course; **tatra**—there; **prayātāḥ**—departed; **gachchhanti**—go; **brahma**—Brahman; **brahma-vidah**—those who know the Brahman; **janāḥ**—persons;

Fire, light, day-time, the bright half of the moon, and the six months of the northward passage of the sun— taking this path, the knowers of Brahman go to Brahman.

VERSE 8.25

धूमो रात्रिस्तथा कृष्णः षण्मासा दक्षिणायनम् ।
तत्र चान्द्रमसं ज्योतिर्योगी प्राप्य निवर्तते ॥ 25 ॥

dhūmo rātris tathā kṛṣṇaḥ ṣhaṇ-māsā dakṣhiṇāyanam
tatra chāndramasaṁ jyotir yogī prāpya nivartate

dhūmaḥ—smoke; **rātriḥ**—night; **tathā**—and; **kṛṣṇaḥ**—the dark fortnight of the moon; **ṣhaṇ-māsāḥ**—six months; **dakṣhiṇa-ayanam**—the sun’s southern course; **tatra**—there; **chāndra-masam**—lunar; **jyotiḥ**—light; **yogī**—a yogi; **prāpya**—attain; **nivartate**—comes back;

Smoke, night, the dark half of the moon, and the six months of the southward passage of the sun— taking this path, the yogi reaches the lunar path and thence returns.

VERSE 8.26

शुक्लकृष्णे गती ह्येते जगतः शाश्वते मते ।
एकया यात्यनावृत्तिमन्ययावर्तते पुनः ॥ 26 ॥

śhukla-kṛiṣhṇe gatī hyete jagataḥ śhāśhvate mate
ekayā yātyanāvṛittim anyayāvartate punaḥ

śhukla—bright; kṛiṣhṇe—dark; gatī—paths; hi—certainly; ete—these; jagataḥ—of the material world; śhāśhvate—eternal; mate—opinion; ekayā—by one; yāti—goes; anāvṛittim—to non return; anyayā—by the other; āvartate—comes back; punaḥ—again

These two paths— the bright and the dark— are deemed to be the world’s eternal paths. Following the one, a man does not come back, and following the other, he is reborn.

VERSE 8.27

नैते सृती पार्थ जानन्योगी मुह्यति कश्चन ।
तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु योगयुक्तो भवार्जुन ॥ 27 ॥

naite sṛitī pārtha jānan yogī muhyati kaśhchana
tasmāt sarveṣhu kāleṣhu yoga-yukto bhavārjuna

na—never; **ete**—these two; **sṛitī**—paths; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **jānan**—knowing; **yogī**—a yogi; **muhyati**—bewildered; **kaśhchana**—any; **tasmāt**—therefore; **sarveṣhu kāleṣhu**—always; **yoga-yuktaḥ**—situated in Yog; **bhava**—be; **arjuna**—Arjun

**No yogi who understands these two paths is ever deluded.
Therefore, O Arjuna, at all times be steadfast in yoga.**

VERSE 8.28

वेदेषु यज्ञेषु तपःसु चैव
दानेषु यत्पुण्यफलं प्रदिष्टम् ।
अत्येति तत्सर्वमिदं विदित्वा
योगी परं स्थानमुपैति चाद्यम् ॥ 28 ॥

vedeṣhu yajñeṣhu tapaḥsu chaiva
dāneṣhu yat puṇya-phalaṁ pradiṣṭam
atyeti tat sarvam idaṁ veditvā
yogī paraṁ sthānam upaiti chādyam

vedeṣhu—in the study of the Vedas; **yajñeṣhu**—in performance of sacrifices; **tapaḥsu**—in austerities; **cha**—and; **eva**—certainly; **dāneṣhu**—in giving charities; **yat**—which; **puṇya-phalam**—fruit of merit; **pradiṣṭam**—is gained; **atyeti**—surpasses; **tat sarvam**—all; **idaṁ**—this; **viditvā**—having known; **yogī**—a yogi; **param**—Supreme; **sthānam**—Abode; **upaiti**—achieves; **cha**—and; **ādyam**—original

The yogi who knows this transcends all the rewards laid down for the study of the Vedas, for sacrifices, for austerities, for making gifts: he reaches the Supreme, Primal Abode.